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In this issue:

1. From the Editor's desk
2. The mystic dipsomania -paratparaswarup
3. Pratyabhijna made easy
4. Etymology of some names from Lalitasahasranama –
Dr. Sujata Tripathi
5. Poems by Prof. Talwar

From the Editor's desk

Einstein is said to have said that algebra is meant for lazy mathematicians, the same adage holds good for tantrism the tantras are meant for lazy yogis who would rather have the fruits of yoga without practicing it. The basic idea is to authorise those who were not eligible for the Vedic rites and rituals owing to some incompetence arising from a lack of passage rites or some deviations amounting to the heresy disposition of an individual or a clan.

A Brahmin who dreads undertaking severe penance as repentance should seek to resort to the tantras. (Kamala Tantra)

The objective however remains the same i.e. Emancipation from all miseries and accomplishment of the supremes bliss, as in the Vedic discipline so in the agamas too. The Agamas are also listed as one of the eighteen faculties in the discipline of Vedic dialectics.

A Kulam is not just a conglomerate but a group with a specific set of conduct that they share. A clan of people committed to some particular ideology who share a collective code of conduct conducive to their creed is a Kulam.

न कुलं कुलमित्याहुराचारः कुलमुच्यते ।

Esoteric precepts which are meant for accomplishing a specific end through means irrespective of their ethical or unethical description are Kulachara. At times these conflict with their exoteric counterpart accruing from their Vedic revelations. This is why we have three categories of tantras Levo, dextro and mixed. The former is bound to any Vedic testimony of evidence for their raison d'être. whereas the third one is always subservient. The middle one is subservient in some matters and defiant in others. The left path is not only deviant but at times deliberately conflicts with conventional norms. The latter remained discreet and carried out their rituals clandestinely and were confined mostly to the lower Strata who were not particular about the purity of race. Even otherwise the simpletons cared least about the authentication of their creed by the testimony of evidence of the revelations. This is the gradual phenomenon that leads to the popularity of the Levo tantrism which decidedly had an edge over its dextrotantric counterpart which lost its agreeability and contemporariness due to excessive dependence on the authentication of the revelations. As Maheswara Nath puts it - "our intuitive insight guided by conscience is our scriptural testimony of evidence". Kalidasa the great poet had already said this many centuries before the compiler of Maharath Manjari.

सतां हि सन्देहपदेषु वस्तुषु प्रमाणमन्तःकरणप्रवृत्तयः।

My opinion is that the intuitive insight guided by conscience is not innate but is induced through a tantric process of shaktipat. only then the awareness with minimised errors and optimised righteousness leads to a flaw less viewpoint of a strategy. The term सतां can be translated as to the "righteous ones ". The agamas do not expect you to righteous or virtuous in the beginning but these down upon an aspirant through shaktipat or (mystic conversion) and renders him competent and well equipped for his spiritual venture which culminates into the realisation of his essential nature -absolute and universal self.

Swami Paranand Tirth

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The mystic dipsomania.

Ah, my Beloved, fill the Cup that clears
TO-DAY of past Regrets and future Fears -
Tomorrow - Why, *Tomorrow* I may be
Myself with Yesterday's Sev'n Thousand Years.

The wine that people usually drink can't avert anxiety for good. It just benumbs your brain but can't clear it off totally. Brooding over the past is an effect of Rajo Guna which is an innate impetus that forces you to ignore the "moment of occurrence of sins " this, in turn, leads to tamas which imprisons you in the quagmire of grief, regret, fear anxiety, sloth, and lethargy. The mindset of essential purity Satva is about being infatuated with only good and virtuous. Since all other moods and emotions are bound to change, merely holding on to sattva is also a type of binding. The Lord says in the Gitasattva binds you with knowledge and comfort.

Don't stick to any of these gunas but focus on transcending them. A man of enlightenment just witnesses their frequenting and remains unattached to them as well as their produces.

The cup Khayyam is talking about is the elixir that follows from meditation. Once you've got the knack of transcending the three gunas you never get involved in them and their produces.

There is a state of super consciousness the yoga scriptures say, in which all guilt, regrets, and complexes are erased from the psyche

With a refreshed mind free from such ailments one can not only perform efficaciously in the present but also shape his destiny.

Patanjali says हेयं दुःखमनागतम्. The past is dead, the future hasn't yet come. So focus only on the present. These time dimensions can be reflected over in any magnitude or minuscule. The preceding eon present eon or future eon or the past plank sec (10^{-36}) present plank sec and the future plank sec.

This ambrosia of meditation can clear all unbecoming impressions of the past and rejuvenate your neuro cerebral system for a better future without actually worrying about it. Once you are on board, the vessel takes care of your locomotion. Your running fast or slow on the deck doesn't count anymore. once you have got the knack of syncing with your essential nature things take care of themselves.

The cup of transcendental bliss seems intoxicating till one realised that it is the room temperature. The permanent absorption into one essential nature is the only deviation. The dexterity lies not in waiting till the mindset restores to its original state but in devising new methods of restricting deviation and tracing one's way back to the original self-evident gnosis. There is a maxim of a directionless man who has lost his way in the middle of the wilderness. He cannot retrace his way back to the right track by exercising his intelligence. No amount of reasoning or contemplation can help him. All it takes is a man who knows the right track -the authentic word or pramanam.

One of the famous commentators on Patanjali's yoga aphorism says that the suffering that has not yet come must be cast off from the mind. हेयं दुःखमनागतम्

Most of our sufferings arise from the innate fear of death and deprivation. This thanatic drive governs the interactions Mental or physical. To transcend the conventional mindset, one must use some knacks devised by ancient yogis who have descended from their state of superconscious bliss to help those who are still striving. Only dialectic erudition is of no use in matters about the subjective experience. Their import in defining and conveying the experience however remains unquestioned. That explains why the Vedic metaphysics lays more emphases on a preceptor being a scholar as well as an enlightened being I.e. श्रोत्रिय ब्रह्मनिष्ठ. Only a scholar cannot guide you properly. Only an enlightened being has no intellectual means of interpreting his spiritual experience into a cognizable postulation. The mystic in this quatrain is aiming at the immaculate guileless disposition of the timeless and essential nature. The cup of wisdom removes both.

तदधिगम उत्तरपूर्वाघयोरक्षेषविनाशौ । The aphoristic canon of Brahm says after the knowledge of the self has Downed upon the aspirant. His sins of the past are liquidated and he is no more involved in the doer-ship as well as fruition of karmas a posteriori of epiphany.

Brooding over the past and anxiety of the future occupy ninety percent of the psyche, besides motivating for further reciprocation of the trail of misgivings they also impede and thus condition the progress of an aspirant who wants to remain seated in his spiritual magnanimity. The past is dead says Bhima and the future hasn't come as yet. So a yogi should be present in the present only. The continuum of this awareness before the mind is shadowed by past experiences or doodle and re Erie of the future imagery. Khayyam calls this mystic intoxicant a cup of divine elixir. Somewhat like conventional wine, it erases all past impressions good or bad from the mindset. The only difference being that the former erases them in toto and they do not crop up again. Whereas the latter just remains oblivious of the imprints dormant in the mind till the kick is over. A dipsomaniac wakes up in the same mental niche which he left behind, A man who is drunk with divine elixir awakes into an entirely different mindset which is devoid of all misgivings which are the reciprocations of an aberrant world view caused by nescience. The most peculiar thing about this divine intoxication is that it is innate and perse.

There is an analogy of two pals both happened to drink ambrosia that would make them immortal. One of them knew that he has partaken elixir and thus attained immortality whereas the other one despite being immortal like his friend did not know it. Both were immortal but the latter dreaded death and deprivation just the same. The cup that talks about is the divine ambrosia drunk deliberately, mindfully, and consciously and thus relishing one's eternal and immortal nature. Today of past regrets and tomorrow's fears are not forgotten so easily, conventional alcohol and for that matter, all other additives and intoxicants cannot clear these. The blissful wine of superconsciousness or samadhi is just what erases all such impressions from the mind. The exponent of yoga says,

तज्जः संस्कारो अन्यसंस्कारप्रतिरोधी

The impressions generated by superconsciousness counteracts the impressions generated by the conventional trail of the input of stimuli and responses into the psyche'.

The kick of this mystic dipsomania - hair on the dog's tail -leads to total cleansing a catharsis that clears the haze of aberrant misgivings which has been blocking the subjective experience of one's universal nature.

Bread for the Multitudes

I am the bread
on night of the moon
I am the wheat that rises
from the Earth
on night of the moon
when the dews fall
to feed the seeds
I am the bread
that is born
that rises
like sun the flower
poppy plucked whose seeds
dried sprinkled baked...
I am the bread
food for the multitudes
for times past and arriving
I am the wealth the bread that was...
Now tastes linger
in mouths of hungry
who are forgotten?

who have forgotten
what milk tasted like
how it felt warm even
from beloved mother's breast...

I am the bread
on night of golden moon
when everything is full
rich luscious
waiting to be tasted
to be touched.

How the cup did run over...

I am still that wealth
born cradled among green
sleeves in baking warmth
the food the bread
the breast that brings to rest
the singing grain the wild fields
that run into lap of moons
silently when no one watches.

Are you listening?

So I may nourish the forgotten
the forgetting

So I not stray but follow
shine of moons and greet
the honeybee sweetening
my body with leavening...

I am still the bread
I readily ask for succour
So we may be whole
again: you and me...
the world over

Prof.Ambika Talwar

4 PRATYABHIJNA HRIDAYAM made easy

1 Sutra

चिति सङ्कोचात्मा चेतनोपि सङ्कुचितविश्वमयः

2 Translation

Contracted Chiti in the form of consciousness is also embodied as contracted Vishwa or universe

3 Exposition

The constricted aspect of consciousness is also a universe in a dormant form.

When Shiva wants to manifest as Sadashiv, Ishwar, etc which are, his grosser forms, the universal phenomenon with which he was in unison remains, in the form of pure subjective 'consciousness'. In that state of Shunya (void) and Atishunya (supervoid) Shiva remains as pure Prakasha (unalloyed subjective awareness). Then that consciousness consolidates while getting grosser and manifesting in the form of the phenomena consisting of Tattvas and Bhuvanas and becomes the Pramata (knower) of those respective gradations of manifestations. Since the entire universe is the embodiment of Shiva even the consciousness which is conditioned as the constricted 'Chittam' (Heart or Mind) is also Vishwarupam or a form of universal phenomenon i.e. The universal phenomena is also embedded in the conditioned experience just as a huge fig tree is latent in a tiny fig seed. Just as the lord is the "universe embodied" so is the contracted conditioned experient. The two types of manifestation of the Lord as the universe are

1) Vishottirna Shiva (Universe as a singular entity)

2) Vishwamaya Shiva (Multiple Embodiments within the universe)

[some corollaries of pratyabhijna doctrine also include both vishwottirna and Vishwa Maya i.e. world transcendent as well world pervasive]

Anashrit Shiva: The transcendental one. The aspect of Shiva that manifests independently and Anashrit Bhuvana is beyond 224 Bhuvanas. As Chid-Ras (the fluid of consciousness) gets consolidated, it manifests as Sadashiv, Ishwar, Vidya, and so forth. In a Tantra called 'Trisiro Mat,' the universal form of Trisiro Bhairava is given in one verse which says that "He pervades the entire universe, he is the quality of solidity in the earth, fluidity in water, heat in the fire, motion in air and sound in the ether". The Universe is made from these five constituents. Since he manifests as these five the whole universe is his embodiment. Hence even an empirical and conditioned experient is actually of a universal nature. So even the contraction (sankoca) in fact is of the nature of Prakasha and is all-pervasive.

The universal manifestation of Prakasha itself unites with Maya and accounts for the contraction (sankoca) which is, in fact, apparent due to unmanifest or dormant form of the real nature due to Maya shakti. This contraction or conditioning is also nothing else but pure consciousness only since it manifests as of a conscious nature. Thus the experient is embodied as a universal phenomenon and therefore is Shiva himself. There is a logic to vindicate this phenomenon.

Questions:

1) As Shiva manifests as lesser embodiments, he is actually conditioned

Yes/ No/ Can't Say

2) Conditioned consciousness as Chittam is a fragment of the universe

Yes/ No/ Can't Say

3) Transcendental Shiva is the same as the one that interlaces all elements

Yes/ No/ Can't Say

4) Sankoca is caused by Maya

Yes/ No/ Can't Say

Please mail the answers to the google classroom of YTA YOGA TANTRA AND AGAMA.

The etymology of some names from the Lalita Sahasranam

[English rendering of a Sanskrit paper read by Prof. Sujata Tripathi at YTA colloquium]

श्रीसुन्दरीसेवनतत्पराणां भोगश्च मोक्षश्च करस्थ एव - Path to enlightenment has no enjoyments and vice versa. If one relishes worldly enjoyments there is no emancipation. But for a docile worshipper of the graceful goddess of beauty -Shri Sundari, both are available.

Shri Mata –

The term **Shri** signifies both the consort of Shiva and Bharati, the consort of Brahma, the presiding deity of learning. Hence the mother of both goddesses. It is commonplace that a mother comes for the deliverance of her offspring from miseries and distress. This is why during distress only the mother is remembered. Only mothers can remove our three-fold grievances. Owing to her prowess of removing extreme distress, the universal mother must be felicitated. This comprises the purpose of this compilation. Even for attaining salvation, the divine mother must be felicitated. The thesaurus called *vyadi* defines -the term Shri as - लक्ष्मी-सरस्वती-धी-त्रिवर्ग-सम्पत्-विभूति-शोभसु i.e. affluence, wisdom, intelligence, the three objectives of human life -wealth, comfort and righteousness, wealth, grandeur, and agreeability. Nevertheless owing to the genetrix of Gauri and Bharati -the **shree** can not be categorised as similar to these two. On the other hand, she is propounded as the mother of the consorts of Rudra, Vishnu, and Brahma i.e. the supreme empress of lord Paramashiva. Another etymology of the word **shree** is the entity that illuminates or conditions Lakshmi. The conditioning entity is more extent and pervasive and thus necessarily exceeds -the conditioned one. Therefore, emancipation or moksha can also be defined as infinite grace or unlimited grandeur [अनवधिकश्रीः] as one Vedic verse goes -

सा हि श्रीरमृता सतां [shri is the famous goddess of grandeur and immortality in righteous people]

Or, as the Vedic meter goes - यो ब्रह्माणं विदधाति पबर्ब यो वै वेदांश्च प्रहिणोति तस्मै (One who bears Brahma the creator and confides the knowledge of the Vedas to him).

Shri also means poison- one who limits [मति] or places it within her/his throat श्रीम्. This name however is in the masculine gender. There is a tradition that says that one should use the superlative shree before the names of-

Great people and entities e.g. Shri chakram, Shri shailam, Shir vidya, Shri phalam, etc. are the synonyms of the supreme mother. This also signifies that she is the genetrix of the primordial “word”

Sri maharajni

Other subsidiary goddesses like Bharati etc. are merely queens or Rajni but the supreme divine mother is the great empress. This means she is authorised for the sustenance of the entire universal phenomena. In this context, since the word raj ends with na, on being compounded by the prefix mahat, according to the sutra आन्महतः समानाधिकरणजातीययोः -on extending the brevis or introducing aatva, the word maharajni becomes a compound of the type in which the middle portion is eliminated [madhyama pada lopah]. This name cannot be derived by adding a suffix डीप् [used for changing the gender]. In that case, the word derived will be maharajee and not maharajni.

Shreematsimhasaneshwari

Simhasanam is the throne meant for the sitting of a coronated monarch. The prefix “sim” in this word refers to excellence; this is a compound like *rajadanta*. In Devi puranam, this has been explained as owing to her being a

little girl who rode a lion while slaying the demon Mahishasura. Hence the divine goddess came to be called Simhasaneshwari or the one who is seated on a lion. According to a grammatical rule called *varna vyatyaya* - simha refers to ahimsa upon reversing the order. From the root hims, simha is derived. On applying to the maxim of reversal of syllabus [*varna vyatyaya*] *pashyaka* [seer] becomes *kashyapa*. Therefore simha can be construed to mean the remover of violence – *हिंसायाः क्षेपणम्*. The complete meaning will be to cast away violence or the violent ones which only the supreme goddess can accomplish.

Chidagni kunda sambhuta –

Born from the sacrificial pit of the fire of consciousness. Chit is the absolute Brahman. The absolute Brahman is a fire pit of consciousness. Fire is the analogy due to it being effulgent and thus conflicting darkness of nescience. In this parlance, the absolute Brahman has been referred to as consciousness of chit. The root *bhu* meaning to spring forth means differently e.g. born from or produced from [*तत्र जातः, तत्र भवः* -panini]. The popular sacrificial fire altar may be understood as chit or consciousness. In this case, there will a compound called upamit samasa in which one of the components is a simile of the other. The use of the word *jnanagni* in a conto of the Gita is in a similar sense – *ज्ञानाग्निः सर्वकर्माणि भस्मसात् कुरुतेऽर्जुन* (O Arjuna just as the fire of wisdom burns down all karmas). In this context, the supreme goddess was born or incarnated from the sacrificial fire pit of consciousness.

Deva karya samudyata

Eager to accomplish the task of Devas. Gods invoke the goddess to relinquish demons like Bhanda, Mahisha etc. and owing to a promise she gave to the Gods, she is always diligent in accomplishing their task - i.e. slaying the demons and re-establishing their regime in the kingdom of heaven. Despite the absence of modification of Prakriti, no compound or samasa is possible -as per the sutra ‘*तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी तेन सह*’. But still according to the sutra- the *Shashti samasa* or compound with the sixth case, the compound is possible.

Udyadbhanu sahasrabha -

Bearing a hue comparable to thousands of rising suns. Bhanu is derived as an entity with thousands of rays or *sahasrabhanu* i.e., surya or the sun. The attribute udayat [while rising] refers to present tense or lat Lakara. Two suffixes शतृ and शानच् are used in the sense of present tense which pertains to the ‘redness’ comparable to the red hue of thousands or infinite rising suns -which means excessively red hue.

Swatantra tantra says

स्वात्मैव देवता प्रोक्ता लहरी विश्वविग्रहा ।

लौहित्यं तद्विसर्शः स्यात् उपास्तिरिति भावना ॥

The self as the universal manifestation is called the goddess. Contemplation on her being the self is meditation on the red effulgence, and Upasana means - an emotional effort or Bhavana.

Vamkeshari tantra also says-

स्वयं हि त्रिपुरा देवी लौहित्यं तद्विमर्शनम् - The self is goddess Tripura and contemplation on this fact is meditating on her red hue.

The goddess who manifests in the form of Prakasha and vimarsha has three forms -gross, subtle, and causal. The gross form is with forms with all parts and limbs, the subtle form is in the form of a mantra or the mystic form, and the causal manifestation is in the form of vasana or refined will.

Chaturbahu samanvita- ragaswaroopapashadhya-

Perfectly Adorned with four beautiful arms. This signifies the mantra encrypted in the verse depicting the form for meditation. A special form of thought construct is raga or infatuation. The gross aspect of this infatuation is the weapon called noose - पाश. Wrath is a thought construct arising for avarice which is also analogous to knowledge.

Martandabhairavaradhya-

Martanda bhairava is the presiding deity of the sun god. She is called so due to her being worshiped by martanda bhairava. This is para form owing to it being included in the group beginning from skanda. This has been mentioned several times in the kalika puranam. Padma purana says that the sun adores an idol of the divine

goddess made from gems and jewels, from whom he attained the position of the effulgent Bhaskar [lit by the one who illuminates]. A cluster of furious entiotiers is also meant by the word bhairavam. In the markandey purana

while felicitating the goddess, it has been said that – दुर्गे सगमृता हरसि भीमितशेषजनगतोः (thou dispelled the fear of the entire world).

Shiv sutras depict bhairava as a strenuous effort. This is what is required to dispel ignorance.

Mantrini nyasta Rajyadhoo-

Mantrini means shyamala- the Minister for the supreme empress who provides consultation for facilitating the regime. This name means- the one whose regal burden is shouldered by mantrini or the chief minister.

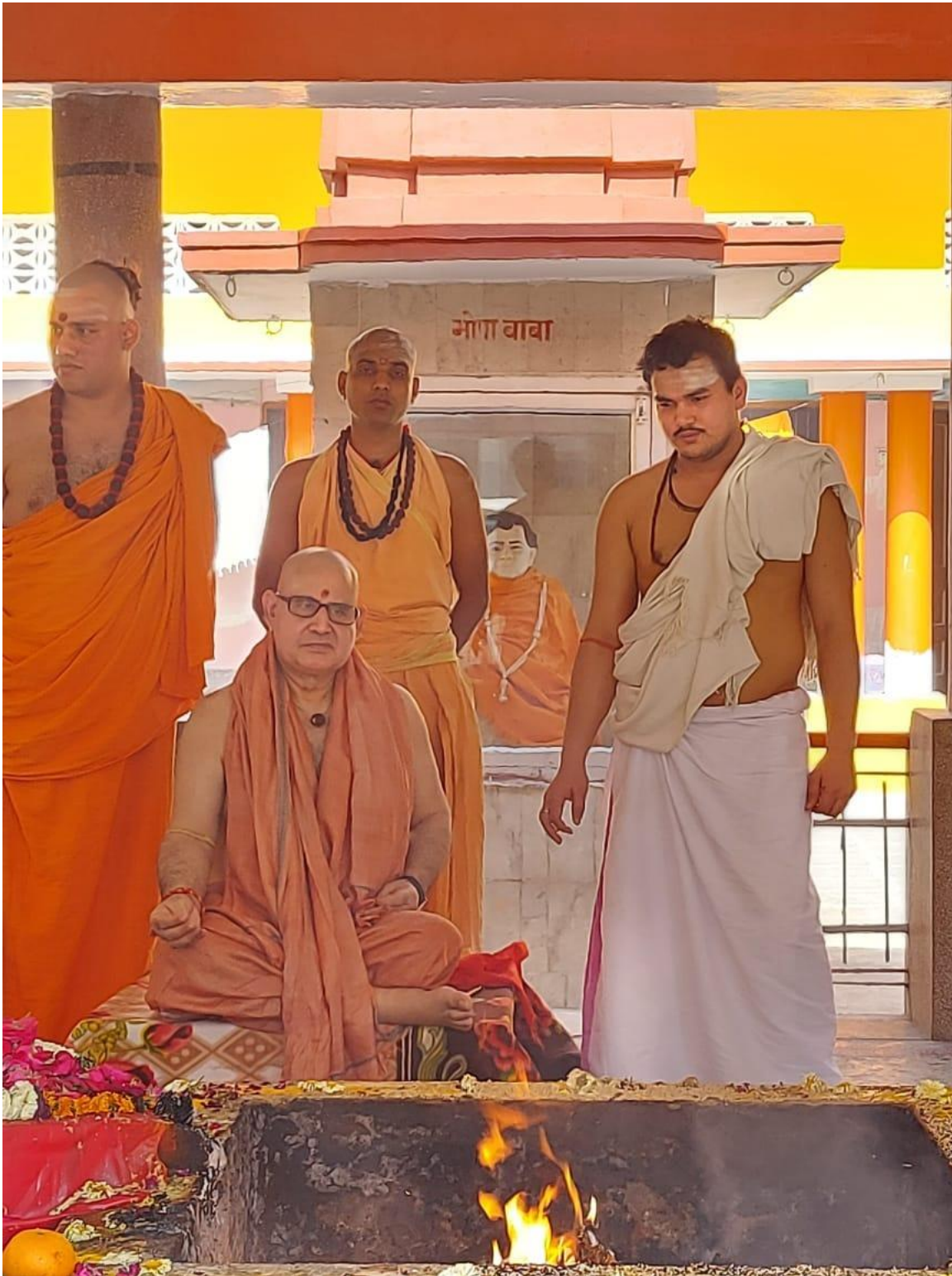
A Mantri is the worshipper of a particular mantra and a mantra is a syllable that delivers through cogitation, which can be metaphorically called as a pure and refined mind. Those who have this are also named mantris. The special effort that leads on such a Mantri to the unison with the supreme goddess, hence Mantrini. The supreme empress places all the responsibility of her regime [the entire universe]. “धः” means the attribute about the virtue of unison of the

empress with her regime.

(English rendering by varni paratparswarup.)



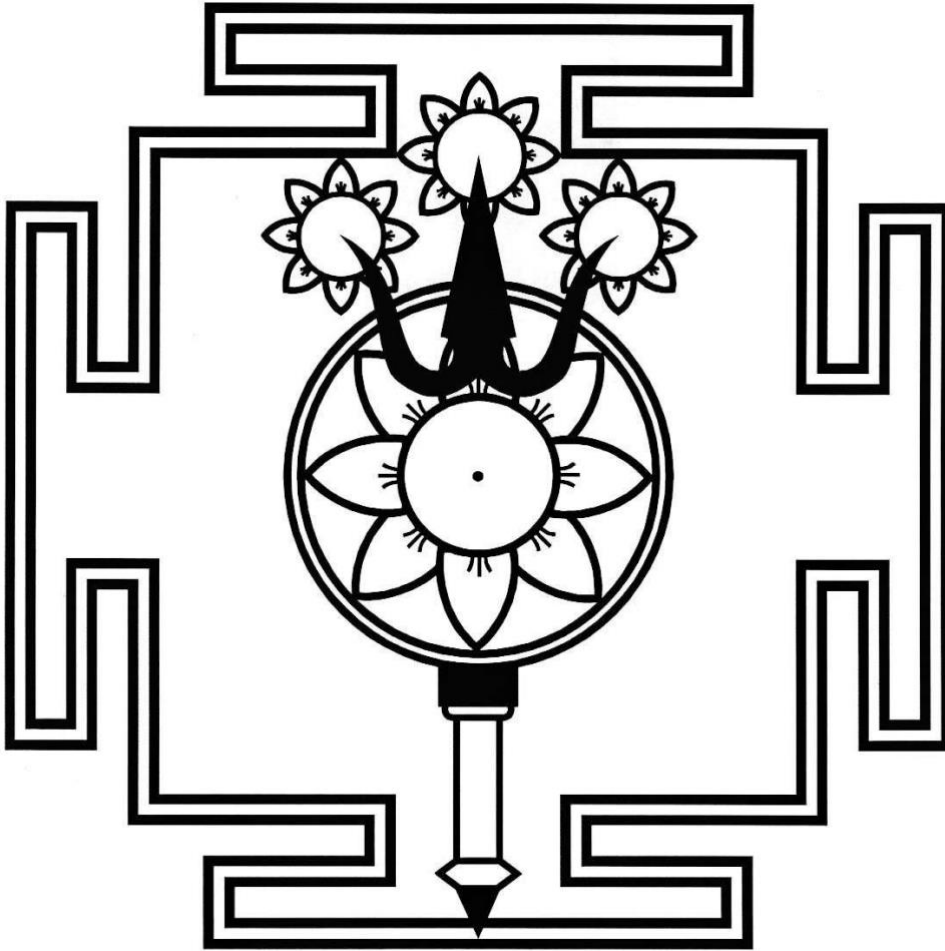
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